VICTORIA UNIVERSITY OF WELLINGTON
TE HERENGA WAKA

WELLINGTON SCHOOL OF BUSINESS AND GOVERNMENT | ŌRAUARIKI

2026 WSBG Doctoral Colloquium

Programme and Abstracts

Friday 30 October 2026
Te Herenga Waka — Victoria University of Wellington

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Presenter, discussant, chair: who does what?

A short, friendly guide to the roles at the colloquium

First, the good news: a doctoral colloquium is not a job talk and it is not your thesis examination. Everyone in the room is either a PhD student or someone who used to be one and still remembers what it felt like. The day has two purposes: to make each other's research better, and to practise the habits of academic conferences in a friendly room before you meet them in a less friendly one.

Nobody ever explains what a presenter, discussant or chair is supposed to do. You're expected to just know. Geoff, Mary and Martien thought it was time someone wrote it down, so here it is.

How a session works

Each parallel session lasts 90 minutes and has three papers, so each paper gets about 30 minutes:

15 min	**Presenter**	presents the research
5 min	**Discussant**	gives prepared comments and questions
10 min	**Everyone**	presenter responds; questions and discussion from the room

Your chair may adjust this a little, but plan around it. The four sessions run in parallel and people switch rooms between papers, so keeping to time matters.

If you are presenting

Your job is to tell us four things: **what your question is**, **why it matters**, **what you are doing (or found)**, and **what you would like help with**. That's it.

- **15 minutes is shorter than you think.** Aim for 10–12 slides and rehearse once with a timer. Present one paper, chapter or question, not the whole thesis.
- **Early-stage work is welcome.** Quite a few of you described your research as early-stage. A colloquium is the best place for ideas that are still maturing, because feedback is most useful *before* any data are collected.
- **Think of finishing with a "help wanted" slide.** One or two questions you'd like the room's view on. You'll get much better feedback than from "Any questions?" or "Thank you".
- **Send your material to your discussant about a week ahead.** Your slides, a draft paper or an extended abstract all work. Tell them what kind of feedback would help most.
- **During the discussion, take notes,** or ask a friend to. You don't need an answer to every question on the spot. "That's a good point, I hadn't considered it and I'll look into it" is a perfectly professional reply.

If you are a discussant

This role sounds the scariest but is usually the most fun. A discussant is a fellow PhD student or fellow academic who reads the paper beforehand and opens the conversation after the presentation. Think of yourself as a **well-prepared, friendly first reader**. You are not a referee and you are not an examiner. You aren't grading anything; you are starting a conversation.

A five-minute recipe

1. **Summarise the paper in one or two sentences** (30 seconds). This shows the presenter what came across, which is useful in itself.
2. **Say what works** (1 minute). Pick two things you genuinely liked and be specific.
3. **Raise two or three questions or suggestions** (3 minutes). For example: Is the research question clear? Do the data and method fit the question? What's the "so what", and who should care? What would a sceptical reader ask? Is there a paper, dataset or theory that might help?
4. **Hand over to the room with one bigger question** (30 seconds).

What you do *not* need

- **To be an expert in the topic.** An outsider's view is often very valuable. Journal referees and thesis examiners are often not specialists either, and "I didn't follow this step" is useful feedback.
- **Slides.** Notes on a card are fine. If you use slides, keep it to one or two.
- **To find a fatal flaw.** Criticism is fine, but you're helping the paper, not demolishing it.

Preparation takes an hour or two: read the material, jot down notes, sort them into the recipe above. If you like, have a coffee with the presenter beforehand and ask what they'd find most useful.

Why it's worth doing

Discussing trains the same skill you need for your literature review and, later, for refereeing: reading critically and constructively. People remember a good discussant, often better than they remember the paper. It's a line on your CV, and it's good practice: at many conferences in business, economics and finance, every paper has a discussant.

More than half of the papers still need a discussant. If you are presenting, you can discuss a paper too. PhD students who aren't presenting are very welcome too. Let Mary or Martien know and we'll match you with a paper.

If you are chairing

The chairs are faculty members, but it's worth knowing what they do, because one day you'll be doing it. A good chair is mainly a friendly timekeeper:

- **Start on time** and introduce each presenter briefly: name, school, title. Twenty seconds is enough.
- **Keep time** by signalling or showing a card at 5 minutes and 1 minute to go, then "please wrap up". A session that runs late eats into the next presenter's time.
- **Run the discussion:** discussant first, then a short reply from the presenter, then questions from the floor. Spread questions around, make sure they really are questions, and step in kindly if a discussion gets stuck or heated.
- **Have a question ready** in case the room is quiet.
- **Thank everyone and finish on time.**

If you are in the audience

Ask questions! A question is a gift to the presenter, and the one you think is too basic is usually the one half the room was wondering about. Be constructive: before speaking, ask yourself whether you would like to receive the comment. And if you can, stay for all three papers in a session.

Worries we've heard (or guessed)

"My English isn't perfect." Most of the room works in a second language. Clear beats polished every time.

"What if I get a question I can't answer?" That happens to everyone, including professors. Say so, write it down and thank the person for the idea.

"What if my discussant criticises my work?" That's the point, and it's a gift. Criticism of a paper is not criticism of you, and it's far better to hear it now than from an examiner.

"I don't know the topic of the paper I'm discussing." Good. You're the intelligent outsider, and that is exactly the reader the presenter needs to convince.

See you on Friday 30 October!

Session M1: Climate Transition, Disclosure and Financial Consequences **11:00–12:30** · RH204

Van Nguyen Thi

School of Economics and Finance

Mandatory climate-related disclosure regulation and firms' cost of equity capital: International evidence

PRIMARY SUPERVISOR	Thu Phuong Truong
CONTRIBUTION	Paper presentation
DISCUSSANT	TBC
SESSION CHAIR	Bob Buckle
FACULTY MEMBER	Tiong Goh
SLOT	Friday 30 October, 11:00–12:30, room RH204 (presentation 1 of 3)

Abstract

Carbon pricing is intended to influence firms' economic decisions and facilitate the reallocation of capital toward a low-carbon economy. Its effectiveness, however, depends partly on whether carbon prices convey economically meaningful information that is incorporated into financial asset prices. This issue is particularly important in New Zealand, where the New Zealand Emissions Trading Scheme (NZ ETS) is the country's primary market-based climate policy instrument and has undergone substantial institutional change, including its delinking from international Kyoto markets in 2015 and the introduction of government auctions in 2021.

This study examines three related questions: whether unanticipated carbon price shocks are reflected in the stock returns of New Zealand listed firms; whether this relationship changes as the institutional design and domestic relevance of the NZ ETS evolve; and whether firms' responses differ across industries and levels of carbon intensity.

Using daily data for 172 firms listed on the New Zealand Exchange (NZX) from May 2010 to May 2025, together with daily New Zealand Unit (NZU) spot prices, the study constructs unanticipated carbon price shocks as standardized innovations from an AR(7)-EGARCH(1,1) model. Firm fixed-effects panel regressions examine contemporaneous and lagged stock-market responses while controlling for domestic and international financial and macroeconomic factors. Structural-break tests compare the internationally linked and post-delinking regimes, with a three-regime specification further distinguishing the post-delinking domestic-market period from the auction era. Industry and carbon-intensity analyses examine heterogeneous firm exposure.

Preliminary findings indicate that unanticipated NZU price shocks contain value-relevant information for New Zealand equity investors. Stock-market responses are positive and persistent, with the strongest effects often appearing with a one-day lag, while negative shocks generate stronger average responses than positive shocks. Importantly, the carbon-equity relationship is strongly regime-dependent: carbon price shocks have limited explanatory power during the internationally linked period, become substantially more informative following delinking, and remain relevant, although more moderately, during the auction era. The response also varies across industries and firms with different carbon intensities.

The study contributes to the climate-finance literature by providing evidence from a small, policy-driven emissions trading system and showing that the financial-market relevance of carbon prices depends not only on carbon-price movements themselves but also on the institutional framework that determines their informational content. It highlights the importance of credible, domestically informative carbon-price signals for the transmission of climate policy into financial markets.

Keywords: Carbon Pricing; Stock Returns; Emissions Trading Schemes; Institutional Credibility; Climate Finance.

Session M1: Climate Transition, Disclosure and Financial Consequences **11:00–12:30** · RH204

Mariam Girgis

School of Accounting and Commercial Law

Costly Signals, Operational Silence: Transition Plan Credibility and Emissions in NZBA Banks

PRIMARY SUPERVISOR	Martien Lubberink
CONTRIBUTION	Paper presentation
DISCUSSANT	TBC
SESSION CHAIR	Bob Buckle
FACULTY MEMBER	Tiong Goh
SLOT	Friday 30 October, 11:00–12:30, room RH204 (presentation 2 of 3)

Abstract

The Net-Zero Banking Alliance (NZBA) members commit to align lending and investment portfolios with net-zero emissions by 2050. Using euro-area credit registry data, Sastry et al. (2024) find no evidence that joining NZBA increases exposure to renewables or reduces exposure to high-emission sectors, as the commitment raises ESG ratings. Bingler et al. (2023, 2024) reach a similar conclusion in a broader sample: vague net-zero commitments are followed by faster emissions growth, whereas specific and costly commitments are associated with better outcomes. This distinction between cheap talk and costly, validated signalling is now central to the greenwashing literature, which treats validated commitments as the correction for vague ones (Furrer et al., 2012; Giannetti et al., 2023). This study examines whether costly validation alone produces better outcomes or requires operational disclosure to do so.

The existing empirical literature proxies credibility with single-dimensional measures. For example, framework-based content scoring captures structured alignment, mostly against the TCFD framework, but not whether commitments are quantitatively substantiated (Bui et al., 2020; Caby et al., 2022; Demaria & Rigot, 2021; Pitrakkos & Maroun, 2020). Third-party ratings such as CDP and SBTi provide external validation but on narrow criteria. CDP uses scoring points that reward the completeness of disclosure rather than target ambition, and SBTi validates methodological alignment without capturing implementation (Matsumura et al., 2014; Nishitani et al., 2020; Ott et al., 2017). Readability metrics capture linguistic clarity but not disclosure substance (Bingler et al., 2022; Loughran and McDonald, 2014; Nik Ahmad and Hossain, 2019). More methods use computational text analysis to extract specific claim types with increasing precision (Bingler & Colesanti Senni, 2022; Colesanti Senni et al., 2024) without framework compliance or third-party validation.

Each of these traditions measures one facet of credibility. None captures the construct as defined by international standards, which require credible transition plans to include governance, ambition, implementation, metrics, transparency, and engagement (FSB, 2025; IFRS S2, 2023; NGFS & Banque de France, 2023; OECD, 2022). No single indicator fully reflects this definition. Empirical studies cannot yet separate banks that build credibility across multiple disclosure attributes from banks that satisfy only a single criterion. Nevertheless, they cannot differentiate between disclosures and real actions.

My study addresses this measurement gap by analysing 91 NZBA member banks across 30 countries over 2020–2022. It reflects the voluntary disclosure era before the incorporation of the TCFD into IFRS S2, which took effect in 2024. This period captures the voluntary and normative pressures that shape banks' climate commitments rather than mandatory reporting requirements, so cross-bank variation reflects choices about how to construct credibility.

I build a multidimensional credibility measure from five indicators: content analysis scoring, quantified transition-plan statements derived from a large language model, readability, SBTi target validation, and CDP third-party assurance. Principal component analysis reduces these indicators to two latent dimensions: an overall credibility dimension and a symbolic-narrative dimension. I use the position of each bank-year observation in this two-dimensional space to derive four empirical clusters: Credible Substantive, Credible Symbolic, Greenwashing, and Minimal.

The primary results indicate that banks in the Greenwashing and Minimal clusters exhibit systematically higher emission intensities than Credible Substantive banks. The results also concern banks in the Credible Symbolic cluster, as they show emission intensities marginally higher than the Credible Substantive benchmark and nearly as close to the Minimal Cluster despite having costly commitmen

Keywords: Bank transition plans; disclosure credibility; greenwashing; costly signalling; multidimensional measurement.

Session M1: Climate Transition, Disclosure and Financial Consequences **11:00–12:30** · RH204

Tangtai Liang

School of Marketing and International Business

How Regulatory Pressures Shape Environmental Performance of MNEs in Carbon Intensive Industries: The Moderating Roles of Normative Pressures, Cognitive Pressures, and Green Innovation

PRIMARY SUPERVISOR	Revti Raman
CONTRIBUTION	Paper presentation
DISCUSSANT	TBC
SESSION CHAIR	Bob Buckle
FACULTY MEMBER	Tiong Goh
SLOT	Friday 30 October, 11:00–12:30, room RH204 (presentation 3 of 3)

Abstract

Introduction
Despite growing research on environmental sustainability in international business and strategy, the role of multinational enterprises (MNEs) in addressing environmental performance challenges remains contested (Sharma, 2026). While some MNEs lead and champion environmental sustainability initiatives, others resort to greenwashing practices and exploit pollution havens (Bu et al., 2025; Genin & Bu, 2026). Regulations play an important role in influencing MNEs to enhance their environmental performance. However, the role of regulations is also debated. Some scholars argue that stringent environmental regulations can prompt firms to improve environmental performance, whereas others find that MNEs may respond to regulatory pressures by shifting pollution, engaging in symbolic compliance, or merely meeting minimum legal requirements (Aragòn-Correa et al., 2020; Genin & Bu, 2026; Xiong et al., 2025).

This study aims to contribute to the debate on the mixed effects of regulatory pressures by examining how these pressures shape the environmental performance of MNEs. It argues that the effect of regulatory pressures on environmental performance is contingent on normative pressures, cognitive pressures, and a firm's green innovation capability.

This study amis to address three research questions: (1) How do regulatory pressures affect the environmental performance of MNEs? (2) Do normative and cognitive pressures moderate the relationship between regulatory pressures and environmental performance? (3) Does green innovation moderate the relationship between regulatory pressures and environmental performance? (Sharma, 2025; Shui et al., 2025).

Research Contribution
Existing studies report mixed findings regarding the role of regulatory pressures in improving environmental performance, with some studies highlighting environmental improvement and others identifying pollution shifting, institutional arbitrage, and symbolic compliance (Dau et al., 2022; Genin & Bu, 2026; Milosevic et al., 2023). Drawing on institutional theory, this study contributes to the debate by identifying normative and cognitive pressures as key boundary conditions that shape regulatory effectiveness. Furthermore, drawing on the natural resource-based view (Hart, 1995; Hart & Dowell, 2011), the study incorporates green innovation as a firm-level capability explaining why MNEs facing similar regulatory pressures may experience divergent environmental performance (Kano et al., 2025; Sharma, 2025). By focusing on MNEs, the study also provides context-sensitive insights into how multinational operations influence the relationship between regulatory pressures and environmental performance (Zaheer, 2025).

Methodology
This study adopts a quantitative, non-experimental, explanatory longitudinal panel research design. The empirical analysis is based on a sample of 151 Fortune Global 500 MNEs operating in carbon-intensive industries and headquartered in 28 countries over the period 2006-2026. Environmental performance is measured using the ASSET4 Environmental Pillar Score. Regulatory pressure is measured using the Environmental Performance Index (EPI), normative pressure using internet search attention to environmental pollution from Google Trends and Baidu Index, cognitive pressure using industry-level diffusion of ISO 14001 certification combined with industry concentration, and green innovation using green patent applications identified through the WIPO IPC Green Inventory (Genin & Bu, 2026; Hartmann et al., 2021; Ma et al., 2026; Wu et al., 2025). Fixed-effects panel regression models will be employed to test the proposed hypotheses (Wooldridge, 2010).

Findings
Consistent with institutional theory and the NRBV, this study expects that regulatory pressures alone will not generate uniform environmental performance among MNEs. Instead, Its effects depend on the normative pressures, cognitive pressures, and green innovation capabilities.

Keywords: MNEs, Institutional Pressures, Environmental Performance, Green Innovation, Institutional Theory, Natural Resource-based View

Session M2: Gender, Identity and Social Influence **11:00–12:30** · RHMZ01

Verena Habrich

School of Management

Investigating the Intersection of Power Enactment, Leadership, and Gender Inclusion

PRIMARY SUPERVISOR	Karin Lasthuizen
CONTRIBUTION	Paper presentation
DISCUSSANT	Susie Hawthorne
SESSION CHAIR	Michael Winikoff
FACULTY MEMBER	Erin Roxburgh
SLOT	Friday 30 October, 11:00–12:30, room RHMZ01 (presentation 1 of 3)

Abstract

Introduction

Organisations that set out to reduce gender inequality frequently reproduce it. Diversity initiatives are introduced with inclusive intent yet often leave the arrangements that produced exclusion intact (Ely & Meyerson, 2000; Williams et al., 2012). Explaining that gap between intention and consequence requires an account of power. Acker's (1990) theory of 'Gendered Organisations' remains an influential framework for locating gender inequality in organisational life, and Acker herself insisted that its five gendering processes are interconnected. Yet she placed power explicitly within only the first process. Moreover, the framework has been used mostly to document inequalities and prove that organisations are indeed gendered rather than to explain who the relevant actors are, and where the potential for long-term transformation lies (Bates, 2022; Tafvelin & Keisu, 2024). This study examines how power is enacted and how it may shift from control-based, "power-over" to more inclusive "power-with" approaches.

The research questions are: (1) How do leadership practices in comparatively gender-equal organisations adopt power-with (empowerment) versus power-over (control) strategies? (2) How does power enactment influence gender inclusion? and (3) What does this reveal about organisational networks as mechanisms of gendered inclusion and exclusion?

Contribution

The study contributes to Acker's (1990) theory of 'Gendered Organisations' by offering alternative perspectives on organisational behaviour, leadership, gendered power, and power enactment. It argues that power operates across, rather than within a single, gendering process and becomes observable through organisational mechanisms. Organisational networks provide a useful lens because they are formal and informal structures, embody cultural assumptions about who belongs, provide sites of everyday interaction, and shape the resources through which gendered identities are performed. Mechanisms, on this account, reveal how the interconnections Acker theorised operate in organisational life. Repositioning power as operating across the gendering processes shifts the question from where inequality is located to how it travels, who enacts it and where it might be interrupted. The study aims to examine role model organisations and identify their conditions under which power dynamics contribute to offering pathways to greater gender inclusion.

Methodology

I have conducted a systematic literature review with 100 papers, exploring how authors who draw on Acker's theory of 'Gendered Organisations' have conceptualised power and what this reveals about organisational networks as mechanisms of gendered inclusion or exclusion.

Furthermore, I will apply a combination of qualitative expert interviews and a multiple case study design, analysing comparatively gender-equal organisations in New Zealand. Through purposeful sampling the study will focus on large private organisations that have a GenderTick accreditation. Data will be collected through open interviews with leaders, supplemented by document analysis and potentially observations and focus groups, depending on the level of access the case study organisations are granting. The analysis will combine inductive open coding, allowing categories to emerge naturally from the data, and deductive pre-established coding. NVivo will be used for coding, followed by theoretical mapping.

Expected Findings

The study expects to identify how leaders enact power-with versus power-over approaches to achieve gender inclusion, and how they describe mechanisms to enact power, e.g. through formal or informal networks. I believe that organisations that demonstrate strong efforts towards gender equality will likely apply power-with leadership approaches (an empowering and inclusive way of doing power). The way power is enacted will influence female employees' access to information, resources, support, opportunities, and networks.

Keywords: Gendered organisations; power enactment; gender inclusion; leadership; organisational networks

Session M2: Gender, Identity and Social Influence **11:00–12:30** · RHMZ01

Jinxin Zhu

School of Economics and Finance

Fertility and Gendered Structural Transformation

PRIMARY SUPERVISOR	Yao Yao
CONTRIBUTION	Paper presentation
DISCUSSANT	TBC
SESSION CHAIR	Michael Winikoff
FACULTY MEMBER	Erin Roxburgh
SLOT	Friday 30 October, 11:00–12:30, room RHMZ01 (presentation 2 of 3)

Abstract

Structural transformation is characterized by a declining agricultural employment share and the reallocation of resources across sectors. Yet this process is markedly gendered, with women in developing countries disproportionately concentrated in agriculture. This paper studies how fertility shapes gendered structural transformation in China. In particular, we examine whether fertility affects women's and men's sectoral choices differently, and whether these differences matter for structural transformation and aggregate productivity.

Empirical analysis shows that higher fertility is associated with rural women being more likely to work in agriculture and less likely to migrate to urban nonagricultural sectors. These effects are much weaker for men, highlighting the gender-based labor allocation associated with fertility constraints.

To quantify the aggregate implications, we develop a multi-sector general equilibrium model in which households jointly choose the quantity and quality of children, consumption, and sector of employment. Rural households choose among agriculture, rural nonagriculture, and urban nonagricultural migration. The key mechanism is that childrearing time costs are gender- and sector-specific, making nonagricultural employment relatively more costly than agricultural work for women with children. The model also incorporates China's household registration system and the one-child policy.

Counterfactual analysis shows that reducing women's childrearing burden increases female migration, shifts women out of agriculture, and raises aggregate productivity. Sectoral labor reallocation accounts for about 18% of the productivity gain, with most of this effect operating through women's labor allocation. In contrast, removing the one-child policy raises fertility, reduces female migration, and lowers productivity. Additional counterfactuals show that lower migration costs and improvements in rural human capital also promote labor reallocation and productivity growth, with particularly strong effects on female labor allocation.

The paper contributes to the literature on structural transformation by introducing fertility as an endogenous source of gender-specific labor-allocation frictions. It highlights childrearing costs as an important link between household fertility decisions, female labor mobility, and aggregate productivity.

Keywords: Fertility, Gendered Labor Allocation, Structural Transformation, Agriculture

Session M2: Gender, Identity and Social Influence **11:00–12:30** · RHMZ01

Mohamed Abdelmohsen Mohamed Desoky

School of Marketing and International Business

The use of legal performance-enhancing supplements by young adult male non-professional gym users: A social marketing challenge

PRIMARY SUPERVISOR	Valerie Hooper
CONTRIBUTION	Paper presentation
DISCUSSANT	TBC
SESSION CHAIR	Michael Winikoff
FACULTY MEMBER	Erin Roxburgh
SLOT	Friday 30 October, 11:00–12:30, room RHMZ01 (presentation 3 of 3)

Abstract

Commercial gyms are no longer merely places to exercise; they are social and commercial spaces where people pursue body ideals and the consumption of "beneficial" products is facilitated (Sassatelli, 2010). Such products include legal performance-enhancing supplements (legal PES) which are consumed by a significant proportion of young adult males gym users (Ruano & Teixeira, 2020). Legal PES products such as protein powder, creatine, and pre-workout supplements, are purposefully ingested to increase strength, muscle mass, and endurance (Maughan et al., 2018).

Although legally available and widely regarded as safe, legal PES are not risk-free as users often exceed recommended intakes and rarely seek medical advice for adverse effects (Pilegaard et al., 2022). Legal PES are promoted both commercially, through marketing messages emphasising performance and appearance (Catalani et al., 2021), and interpersonally, through peer encouragement and casual advice from friends and trainers (Druker & Gesser-Edelsburg, 2017; Lopes et al., 2024), yet rarely is information conveyed about risks, proper use or long-term effects. In addition, most research on performance-enhancing substances concentrates on the use of steroids and illegal substance use by competitive athletes and professional bodybuilders, leaving a significant gap in the understanding of legal PES use among young males who train recreationally (Hilkens et al., 2021; Sundgot-Borgen et al., 2022).

Legal PES use therefore sits at the intersection of commercial consumption, nutrition and masculine identity (Atkinson, 2007). Previous studies on supplement use have typically applied single theoretical perspectives, such as the Theory of Reasoned Action (Bayır et al., 2024), the Theory of Planned Behaviour (Ajzen, 1991; Haubenstricker et al., 2023) or a social media–body image pathway (Hilkens et al., 2021), rather than a holistic framework examining how individual, social and environmental factors influence each other. Furthermore, although social marketing has addressed behaviours such as healthy eating and alcohol use (Carins & Rundle-Thiele, 2014; Dietrich et al., 2016), legal PES use has received minimal attention from this perspective.

Social Cognitive Theory (SCT) is well suited to addressing this gap. Through reciprocal determinism, it holds that behaviour results from continuous, three-way interaction between the Person (motivation, knowledge, self-image), the Environment (peers, media, marketing, gym culture), and Behaviour itself (Bandura, 1986). Consequently, this exploratory qualitative study will investigate legal PES use among young adult male gym users through the theoretical lens of SCT.

Rather than testing hypotheses, it is guided by three objectives:

RO1: To explore how the Person domain shapes and is shaped by legal PES use among young adult male gym users (Behaviour domain)

RO2: To explore how the Environment domain shapes and is shaped by legal PES use among young adult male gym users (Behaviour domain)

RO3: To explore how the Person domain shapes and is shaped by the Environment domain with regard to legal PES use among young adult male gym users.

Research Contribution
The study will elucidate reciprocal determinism in SCT and, through theory synthesis (Jaakkola, 2020), inform more effective social marketing approaches to legal PES use.

Methodology
A three-phase sequential design (24–30 semi-structured interviews, four focus groups and participatory workshops) will use purposive sampling of English-speaking, Wellington-based males aged 18–35 (stratified 18–25 and 26–35) who attend a commercial gym at least weekly and have used legal PES. Data will be analysed using thematic analysis (Braun & Clarke, 2006).

Expected Findings
The study is expected to show how personal motivations, social norms and gym culture shape legal PES use, and these findings will then inform the development of participant-informed messaging strategies.

Keywords: legal performance-enhancing supplements; Social Cognitive Theory; reciprocal determinism; social marketing; young adult male gym users

Session M3: Strategic Corporate Decisions, Markets and Uncertainty **11:00–12:30** · RH207

Maldeniye Koralalage Chamika Hashani

School of Economics and Finance

Valuation of an Irreversible Investment under Markov Regime Switching

PRIMARY SUPERVISOR	Toby Daglish
CONTRIBUTION	Paper presentation
DISCUSSANT	TBC
SESSION CHAIR	Janet Davey
FACULTY MEMBER	Samina Munir
SLOT	Friday 30 October, 11:00–12:30, room RH207 (presentation 1 of 3)

Abstract

Introduction
Most investments are partly irreversible, uncertain, and flexible in timing. Here, the simple net present value rule fails (Dixit and Pindyck 1994). Investing today gives up the option to wait, so the project must be worth more than its cost. McDonald and Siegel (1986) show this hurdle can be about twice the cost and rises with uncertainty. Drift and volatility, often assumed fixed, shift with the business cycle and policy. Regime-switching models let them follow a finite-state Markov chain, but assume the firm observes the regime (Driffill et al. 2003; Guo et al. 2005; Driffill et al. 2013; Boomsma et al. 2012). Learning models hide the state, and the firm invests when its belief crosses a threshold; but the hidden state never changes (Thijssen et al. 2004; Harrison and Sunar 2015; Shibata 2008; Grenadier and Malenko 2010).

Research Contribution
A regime that is both hidden and switching has little attention. We fill this gap by combining regime switching with real options and using the Wonham filter, which gives exact belief dynamics for a hidden Markov chain. The investment threshold then depends on beliefs, and we show how learning and regime persistence shape investment timing.

Methodology
The project cash flow follows a geometric Brownian motion whose drift and volatility depend on the current regime. There are four regimes, and switches between them follow a continuous-time Markov chain. We group the regimes into a good class and a bad class. Within each class, one regime is persistent and the other is transient. The firm sees the cash flow but not the regime.

The firm forms a belief (a probability) for each regime. These beliefs follow the Wonham filter (Wonham, 1964). The filter has two parts. The first part moves beliefs according to the regime switching rates. The second part updates beliefs using the gap between the observed cash flow growth and the growth the firm expected.

In this first case, the two regimes in each class share the same drift and volatility. Volatility reveals the class but not the regime within it. The second part of the filter then drops out, and beliefs follow a closed-form path over time. We also assume no jumps within a class and fixed jump ratios.

After investment, the firm receives the cash flow in perpetuity. The project value equals the cash flow times a multiple that depends on beliefs. We solve this multiple in closed form. Before investment, the option value in each class solves a partial differential equation in the log cash flow and the belief. The two equations are coupled, because a jump moves the firm to the other class. At the trigger, value matching and smooth pasting hold.

We solve the system with finite differences on a grid of log cash flow and belief. A projected SOR solver handles the early-exercise condition, and fixed-point iteration handles the coupling between classes. The study at this stage is theoretical and uses no empirical data. Illustrative parameter values show how the model behaves.

Findings
The project value multiple is linear in beliefs. At low cash flow, the option value is close to zero. Above the trigger, it rises steeply. The firm in the bad class waits for a higher cash flow than the firm in the good class. The exercise boundary depends on beliefs and splits the state space into action, inaction and transient regions. In the good class, more belief in the persistent best regime lowers the trigger, so the firm invests sooner. In the bad class, more belief in the persistent worst regime raises the trigger, so the firm waits longer. Smooth pasting holds numerically, which supports the accuracy of the solution.

Future work
In the next stage, we will restore the second part of the filter so that beliefs react to the observed cash flow. Beliefs then become random, and adds a second-order term to the equation, so the numerical problem changes.

Keywords: Real Options, Markov Switching, Bayesian Approach, Dynamic Programming, Policy Uncertainty

Session M3: Strategic Corporate Decisions, Markets and Uncertainty **11:00–12:30** · RH207

Athalia Hidayat

School of Accounting and Commercial Law

Long-run Accounting Performance of Divestments and Its Association with Investors' Perceptions of Market Returns

PRIMARY SUPERVISOR	Roger Willett
CONTRIBUTION	Paper presentation
DISCUSSANT	TBC
SESSION CHAIR	Janet Davey
FACULTY MEMBER	Samina Munir
SLOT	Friday 30 October, 11:00–12:30, room RH207 (presentation 2 of 3)

Abstract

Corporations reconfigure their business portfolios through acquisitions and divestments to maximise shareholders' value. Corporations pursue acquisitions to expand or diversify their operations. However, continuous expansion and diversification may no longer maximise shareholder value, and corporations may reach a point where they need to reconsider their business structure. Divestment allows corporations to reallocate resources for future growth.

Divestments used to be opportunistic moves, but now they are strategic decisions focused on resource allocations rather than reactive decisions. Based on data from LSEG Workspace, the number of divestment transactions from the 1980s to 2025 moderated, but the total and average deal value continue to rise. In the 2026 Deloitte Global Divestiture Survey, the leading driver of divestments was the motivation to sharpen strategic focus, redeploy capital, and improve operating model efficiency, compared with the 2024 survey, where regulatory shifts and competitive pressures dominated.

We study the long-term market and accounting performance for two types of corporate divestments: spin-offs and sell-offs. The research questions are: (1) Do spin-offs and sell-offs improve long-run performance following a divestment? (2) Do market returns consistently reflect accounting performance in the long run following a divestment?

We hypothesise that sell-off companies experience greater long-term performance improvements than spin-off companies (H1). We also hypothesise that divestment provides a shock to the long-run relationship between market and accounting equity (H3) and argue that market returns and accounting performance remain consistent in the long run (H2), although investors may adjust their valuation approach to individual accounting variables following a divestment (H4).

We use a sample of 463 spin-offs and 1,345 sell-offs of US firms from 1984 to 2023. We use an event study and analyse the time series of accounting performance ratios for up to 80 quarters before and after the divestment event. To examine market perceptions of firms' accounting performance around divestment events, we utilise Lubberink and Willett's (2025) log-linear value-relevance model in an event study setting. The log-linear model addresses the problems of high volatility and difficult-to-interpret coefficient estimates of the traditional additive linear model. The coefficient estimates in the log-linear model are elasticities that reflect the proportionate effect of each accounting item on market value.

Consistent with H1, we show that sell-off companies experience greater long-term performance improvements than spin-offs. Spin-off firms show little better performance than the non-divesting group, while sell-off firms appear to perform better than the non-divesting group across the three performance ratios. Within the divesting group, accounting ratios of spin-off and sell-off firms either deteriorate or stagnate before the event, then the decline stabilises or recovers after the event. Consistent with H2 and H3, we find evidence that divestment shocks the market-accounting relationship, but that a consistent market-accounting relationship exists in the long run. Consistent with H4, we show that investors focus more on earnings, distributions, and new investment information, and less on book value information, following a divestment event.

To my knowledge, this is the first study in the literature to investigate the market-accounting performance relationship in the divestment context. Methodologically, this study applies Lubberink and Willett's (2025) log-linear valuation model in an event-study context.

Keywords: divestment, spin-off, sell-off, market performance, accounting performance, log-linear model

Session M3: Strategic Corporate Decisions, Markets and Uncertainty **11:00–12:30** · RH207

Erick Mmbando

School of Marketing and International Business

Business lawfare: A conceptual framework for understanding the strategic use of legal systems in market competition

PRIMARY SUPERVISOR	Valerie Hooper
CONTRIBUTION	Paper presentation
DISCUSSANT	TBC
SESSION CHAIR	Janet Davey
FACULTY MEMBER	Samina Munir
SLOT	Friday 30 October, 11:00–12:30, room RH207 (presentation 3 of 3)

Abstract

Legal systems protect rights, enforce agreements and structure economic exchange (North, 1990). They also provide resources through which firms pursue competitive advantage (Bagley, 2008; Bird and Evans, 2024). Lawfare research examines the strategic mobilisation of law in military, political and economic settings, while law-and-strategy research explains how legal capabilities support corporate strategy. Bringing these perspectives together raises a question about when firms' strategic use of legal mechanisms can be understood as Business Lawfare.

This paper asks how Business Lawfare can be conceptualised as a distinct form of competitive strategy and through which legal mechanisms it may operate. It defines Business Lawfare as firms' strategic use of legal actions, threats, institutions or regulatory mechanisms to influence competitive conditions, constrain rivals or shape stakeholder perceptions in pursuit of competitive objectives extending beyond resolution of the immediate legal or regulatory matter. A competitive benefit alone is insufficient for classification; the analysis considers the strategic function of the legal mechanism.

The study adopts a conceptual synthesis approach, integrating lawfare and law-and-strategy literature with research on intellectual property, corporate political and regulatory activity, strategic litigation and litigation finance. It traces the development of lawfare, develops the proposed construct and specifies its boundaries in relation to ordinary dispute resolution, rights enforcement, regulatory lobbying, legal compliance and broader corporate legal strategy. As a conceptual study, it draws on existing literature rather than collecting primary empirical data.

The analysis proposes three broad mechanisms. Intellectual-property lawfare involves the strategic mobilisation of patent and trade-secret mechanisms. Regulatory and administrative lawfare involves legal and institutional processes used to influence competitive conditions. Litigation-based lawfare involves proceedings or credible legal threats used to pursue wider competitive objectives, with litigation finance potentially enabling their deployment. Across these mechanisms, classification depends on the proposed strategic function rather than the legal instrument alone.

Strategic lawsuits against public participation (SLAPPs) illustrate how abusive claims or threats can suppress criticism. Their effects may arise through the costs, stress and intimidation of actual or anticipated proceedings rather than a favourable judicial outcome (Coe et al., 2025, pp. 103, 106–107). Within the proposed framework, SLAPP-based lawfare concerns firms' use of such tactics to suppress public criticism or participation in pursuit of competitive or reputational objectives.

The contribution is a definition and set of conceptual boundaries for examining Business Lawfare. The framework proposes a normatively neutral analytical construct: identifying strategic legal mobilisation does not itself determine whether conduct is lawful, justified or ethical. It provides a foundation for empirical research into organisational capabilities, competition, innovation and how consumers and other stakeholders interpret and respond to corporate legal actions.

Keywords: Business Lawfare, strategic litigation, competitive strategy, legal systems, market competition

Session M4: Health, Care and Sustainable Wellbeing **11:00–12:30** · RHMZ02

Vy Ngo

School of Management

Rethinking Job Crafting in Demanding Frontline Roles

PRIMARY SUPERVISOR	Geoff Plimmer and Dan Langerud
CONTRIBUTION	Paper presentation
DISCUSSANT	TBC
SESSION CHAIR	Mary Tate
FACULTY MEMBER	Isabella Li
SLOT	Friday 30 October, 11:00–12:30, room RHMZ02 (presentation 1 of 3)

Abstract

Frontline healthcare and social service work unfolds alongside human vulnerability. Clinicians routinely support people through trauma, crisis, and complex health or social challenges. In doing so, they must continually respond to others' emotions while managing their own, all without losing sight of the complex technical responsibilities. Job crafting, the self-initiated changes employees make to their job demands and resources, provides an important lens for understanding how clinicians adapt to changing patient needs. Early research has largely celebrated job crafting as a form of expansion and proactive growth, yet this dominant narrative has left unresolved questions about what constitutes job crafting. Similarly, little is known about how environments influence crafting, how different strategies work together, and why employees craft differently. Because frontline care requires ongoing emotional labour alongside technical tasks, understanding job crafting remains incomplete without attending to the emotional dimension of work. The present study integrates emotional labour and job crafting through the Job Demands-Resources (JD-R) model to explain how frontline workers craft their work while managing emotions. Drawing on interviews with 31 nurses and social workers, the study demonstrates that job crafting is a dynamic, context-dependent process. Supportive conditions allow clinicians to adjust how they work, whereas constrained environments narrow these opportunities. Importantly, crafting is not limited to expansion; clinicians draw on a combination of approach and avoidance strategies to manage demands and sustain themselves. In the end, these findings offer insight into how clinicians can care for others without feeling responsible for saving the world, while recognising that healthy boundaries can offer protection without becoming impenetrable walls.

The single overarching question guiding this study is: How do nurses and social workers craft their work within job, team, leadership, and organisational contexts that current scholarship has not fully accounted for?

Four subsidiary research aims follow:

RQ1: How do job demands, including identity-based demands, shape the experience of frontline care work?

RQ2: How do clinicians use emotional labour as an adaptive practice?

RQ3: How do clinicians integrate approach and avoidance crafting in practice?

RQ4: How do organisational and team contexts enable or constrain emotion regulation and crafting?

Keywords: debriefing, job crafting, team crafting, boundaries, multi-disciplinary team, reducing demands

Session M4: Health, Care and Sustainable Wellbeing **11:00–12:30** · RHMZ02

Noel B. Del Castillo

School of Economics and Finance

Causal effects of extreme weather events on mental health service use among older adults

PRIMARY SUPERVISOR	Ilan Noy
CONTRIBUTION	Paper presentation
DISCUSSANT	Ke Wang
SESSION CHAIR	Mary Tate
FACULTY MEMBER	Isabella Li
SLOT	Friday 30 October, 11:00–12:30, room RHMZ02 (presentation 2 of 3)

Abstract

Older adults are particularly vulnerable to extreme weather–related disasters because chronic illness, reduced mobility, and social isolation can heighten psychological distress during and after such events. Yet evidence on how extreme weather affects mental health service use among older adults remains limited, as existing studies often focus on single disasters, short-term outcomes, or self-reported survey data rather than observed health care utilisation. This study estimates the causal effects of exposure to major extreme weather events on mental health service use among older adults in New Zealand. Using longitudinal administrative data, we exploit variation in exposure timing across individuals and regions within a staggered difference-in-differences framework. Exposure to extreme weather events has increased the probability of mental health service use by 1.8 percentage points (approximately 10% relative to baseline) for moderate conditions. Event-study estimates show that these effects are persistent, with utilisation remaining elevated for up to five years after exposure. In contrast, no statistically significant changes are detected for severe mental health conditions, likely reflecting the relatively small number of severe cases.

Keywords: Mental health, older adults, extreme weather events, disasters, staggered difference-in-differences

Session M4: Health, Care and Sustainable Wellbeing **11:00–12:30** · RHMZ02

Natvadee Anatamsombut

School of Marketing and International Business

Marketing system's perspective on ugly food production and consumption

PRIMARY SUPERVISOR	Fandy Tjiptono
CONTRIBUTION	Paper presentation
DISCUSSANT	Regina Riantini
SESSION CHAIR	Mary Tate
FACULTY MEMBER	Isabella Li
SLOT	Friday 30 October, 11:00–12:30, room RHMZ02 (presentation 3 of 3)

Abstract

Introduction and Research Aims

Food loss and food waste are major global challenges, with significant economic, environmental and social consequences (Aschemann-Witzel et al., 2015). One-third of food is lost or wasted annually, accounting for 1.3 billion tons (UNEP, 2024). While food waste refers to food intended for human consumption that is discarded at the retailer and consumer stage (Parfitt et al., 2010), food loss occurs from production up to, but not including, the retail level (Jia et al., 2025). It occurs not only from spoilage or poor handling (De Hooge et al., 2018), but also from strict cosmetic standards applied by retailers (Gustavsson et al., 2011). This produce is referred to as suboptimal or ugly produce (Lombart et al., 2019). It is produce that deviates from normal appearance despite being safe and nutritious (Gustavsson et al., 2011), but is usually excluded before reaching the retail level (De Hooge et al., 2018). While some excluded produce is diverted to alternative uses, such as canned food, other produce is still sent to landfill (De Hooge et al., 2018), contributing to food loss. This means that resources used to grow this produce are wasted for producing food that will never be consumed, such as 25% of fresh water (Payne, 2014), 30% of land, 38% of energy consumption (FAO, 2015). However, we have yet to know where this produce is excluded, since it can occur at any stage within the marketing system (FAO, 2019).

Prior research on suboptimal produce has mainly focused on consumer perspectives, including consumers' acceptance (Makhal et al., 2020), willingness to pay (Puteri et al., 2022) and perceptions (Aschemann-Witzel et al., 2019b). However, suboptimal produce is distributed throughout the marketing system; focusing on one perspective cannot fully explain how interconnected interactions and practices (e.g., grading and diverting) among different actors and stages collectively shape the acceptance of suboptimal produce (De Hooge et al., 2018). Furthermore, studies on suboptimal food in informal markets, where there are diverse institutional arrangements, channels (e.g., wet markets), and varying levels of enforcement (Resnick et al., 2020), remain scarce (De Hooge et al., 2018). It may fail to capture how coordination, standards, and exchange practices differ from a formal market (Hezarkhani et al., 2023).

Thus, this study will adopt a marketing-system perspective to examine how the acceptance and exclusion of suboptimal produce are constructed through the interactions of multiple actors in formal (e.g., supermarkets) and informal market settings (Layton, 2009). This study will also apply institutional theory to examine how rules, norms and standards influence actors' decision-making to accept or exclude such produce. The study examines how interactions among marketing system actors, together with institutional pressures, shape decisions regarding the acceptance, diversion, and exclusion of suboptimal produce across different stages of the marketing system.

The findings are expected to show that the acceptance of suboptimal produce is not only a result of consumer preferences but also of coordinated and routinised practices of actors shaped by quality standards and market norms. These dynamics may lead to stabilised pathways that facilitate the diversion of suboptimal produce into alternative channels or exacerbate its exclusion from the markets.

This study will contribute to food loss research by identifying how system-level interactions and institutional influences shape the pathways of suboptimal produce. It will highlight key points at which exclusion or diversion occurs and inform strategies to reduce avoidable food loss, wasting resources for the produce that will never be consumed, and support sustainable practices.

Methodology

This study will adopt a qualitative methodology to explore participants' experiences (Patton, 2015) and the factors influencing actors' decisions regarding subop

Keywords: Suboptimal produce; Ugly produce; Marketing systems

Session A1: AI, Interpretation and Research Governance **13:30–15:00** · RH204

Wei Cai

School of Information Management

Toward Interpretable Spam Detection: A Structured Error Interpretation Framework for Spam Detection Based on Speech Act Theory and Small Language Models

PRIMARY SUPERVISOR	Tiong Goh
CONTRIBUTION	Paper presentation
DISCUSSANT	Simin Yin
SESSION CHAIR	Martien Lubberink
FACULTY MEMBER	Mohammad Saud Khan
SLOT	Friday 30 October, 13:30–15:00, room RH204 (presentation 1 of 3)

Abstract

SMS spam, including messages used for phishing and fraud, poses serious risks to financial security and personal privacy. Despite government regulation and telecom filtering measures, detection remains challenging as evolving obfuscation techniques are increasingly supported by generative AI. Small language models (SLMs) offer a practical option for SMS spam detection. However, detection performance alone does not establish their reliability, as traditional metrics reveal little about the misclassification patterns.

This study therefore investigates how effectively SLMs detect SMS spam, how false positives (FP) and false negatives (FN) differ, whether their error patterns are shared across models, and what their performance is in adversarial testing. Using the latest SMS spam benchmark dataset with more than 67k messages, we evaluate zero-shot, few-shot, and fine-tuning settings and develop a structured error interpretation framework based on speech act theory. The framework combines message categories, contexts, linguistic realisation, and speech-act scores to characterise overall errors and construct contextual speech-act signatures from persistent hard cases. These signatures guide controlled message generation for adversarial testing.

The results show that fine-tuning achieved the strongest performance, with Qwen3 (8B) reaching an F1 score of 0.9911, comparable to LLaMA3 (70B). Error interpretation revealed distinct FP and FN signatures, alongside similarities between LLaMA3 (70B) and Qwen3 (8B), and between GLM4 (9B) and DeepSeek (8B). Persistent errors highlighted how spam could be missed when framed as affective or practical interpersonal communication, while benign service and commercial messages could be falsely flagged when contain promotion and calls-to-action resembled spam. Signature-guided adversarial testing achieved attack success rates of 79.33%–98.87%, revealing vulnerabilities that traditional performance metrics alone did not capture.

This study contributes to the literature in two key aspects. First, it extends empirical understanding of the applicability of SLMs to SMS spam detection by clarifying their performance across zero-shot, few-shot, and fine-tuning settings. Second, it advances error analysis by developing a structured interpretation framework grounded in speech act theory. By integrating speech acts with message category, context, and linguistic realisation, the framework interprets error patterns and supports adversarial testing, providing a way to evaluate the robustness of SMS spam detection systems.

Keywords: Small language model (SLMs); SMS spam detection; Error Analysis; Linguistic Analysis; Speech act theory

Session A1: AI, Interpretation and Research Governance **13:30–15:00** · RH204

Jiaye He

School of Management

Dividing Labour, Decision Authority, and Accountability with Generative AI: Chinese International Postgraduate Researchers' First Formal Research Papers

PRIMARY SUPERVISOR	Ruth Weatherall
CONTRIBUTION	Paper presentation
DISCUSSANT	Fatema Tuz Jahra
SESSION CHAIR	Martien Lubberink
FACULTY MEMBER	Mohammad Saud Khan
SLOT	Friday 30 October, 13:30–15:00, room RH204 (presentation 2 of 3)

Abstract

Overview
Generative AI (GenAI) is increasingly embedded in higher education, with existing research focusing substantially on academic integrity risks and individual productivity. Less attention has been paid to how GenAI reconfigures the organisation of academic knowledge work, especially among Chinese international postgraduate researchers who navigate English-medium academic writing, disciplinary conventions, and institutional expectations. This study examines how these researchers divide labour, epistemic decision authority, and accountability with GenAI when producing a first substantial research paper in their postgraduate programme.

Drawing on situated delegation (Clarke & Joffe, 2025), boundary work, and an organisational perspective on human–AI collaboration (Hillebrand et al., 2025), the study treats GenAI use as a negotiated division of academic labour. It examines how researchers distinguish, negotiate, or blur delegated task execution and epistemic accountability, and how they repair boundaries when AI output conflicts with disciplinary standards, evidential requirements, or research goals. Epistemic boundary repair refers to practices such as checking original sources, revising or rejecting AI-generated material, modifying prompts, or reclaiming a task from AI in order to maintain or re-establish human judgement and accountability.

Research questions
How do Chinese international postgraduate researchers allocate research tasks, epistemic decision authority, and accountability between themselves and GenAI, and how do they verify, revise, reject, or reclaim AI contributions when these conflict with disciplinary standards, evidential requirements, or their own judgement?

How do supervisory expectations, disciplinary norms, institutional policies, and English-medium academic writing shape these divisions of labour, decision authority, and accountability?

Methodology
This qualitative exploratory study will be conducted at an English-medium university. The study plans to recruit 10–15 Chinese international postgraduate researchers from a range of disciplinary backgrounds, including humanities, social sciences, and STEM. Data will be collected through semi-structured interviews and example-based reflection on concrete research activities, such as prompt iterations, literature notes, and draft revisions. Analysis will use thematic analysis to trace how participants describe task allocation, decision authority, verification, accountability, and boundary repair across situated research workflows. Particular attention will be paid to moments when AI output conflicts with disciplinary expectations, research goals, or participants' own judgement.

Contribution and impact
The study contributes to human–AI collaboration research by extending situated delegation and boundary work to academic knowledge production. It proposes epistemic boundary repair as a way to understand how researchers continually adjust what can be delegated to GenAI and what must remain subject to human judgement and accountability. Empirically, it connects individual AI practices with supervisory expectations, disciplinary conventions, institutional policies, and language-related experiences. The study will offer implications for higher education governance, supervisory practice, and the responsible use of GenAI in postgraduate research. It will inform postgraduate researchers, supervisors, university policy makers, and academic integrity and research governance bodies.

Keywords: Human–AI collaboration; postgraduate research governance; international researchers

Session A1: AI, Interpretation and Research Governance **13:30–15:00** · RH204

Xiliaili Yaolebasi

School of Economics and Finance

The White Spaces of Science: Mapping the Design Space of Female-Teacher Effects

PRIMARY SUPERVISOR	Jan Feld
CONTRIBUTION	Paper presentation
DISCUSSANT	TBC
SESSION CHAIR	Martien Lubberink
FACULTY MEMBER	Mohammad Saud Khan
SLOT	Friday 30 October, 13:30–15:00, room RH204 (presentation 3 of 3)

Abstract

Many countries try to change their teachers' gender mix, partly expecting teacher gender to affect learning (de Gendre et al., 2024). Teacher-gender effects have been widely studied, yet a meta-analysis can only summarise the contexts researchers chose to study. The literature is a non-random sample from the design space: all the ways the question could be studied (Almaatouq et al., 2024). If evidence is concentrated in a few parts of this space, consistent-looking results may reflect where researchers looked, not a general feature of the world, and policies built on them may fail elsewhere.

Rather than treating the literature's average effect as the main result, we aim to learn where evidence lies and how effects vary across designs. Using a design map, a simplified version of the design space, we ask: RQ1: Which parts of the map are covered by the literature, and which combinations of study features remain unstudied ("white spaces")? RQ2: Does the female-teacher effect differ across student gender, national share of female teachers, outcome type, subject and education stage? We expect evidence to be concentrated in a few cells (H1) and the effect to differ across these five dimensions (H2), without predicting direction.

The closest meta-analysis (de Gendre et al., 2024) estimates the same-sex teacher effect: the difference between the female-teacher effects for girls and boys. We differ in three ways. First, we target the female-teacher effect itself and add tertiary education. This matters for policy: hiring female teachers affects both girls and boys, yet the same-sex effect can be zero when both are affected equally. Second, unlike meta-regressions, which only compare features present in studies, our pre-specified map also shows combinations never studied. Third, we add newly generated estimates, which can fill white spaces and are not filtered by publication.

The design map is the core of the method; meta-analytic models estimate effects within it. Defined in the pre-analysis plan, the map has six dimensions: student gender; national share of female teachers; outcome type (grades or test scores); identification strategy (how a study isolates the teacher-gender effect), used only to assess credibility; subject; and education stage (primary, secondary, tertiary).

Estimates come from two sources. The first is a meta-analytic literature search of Google Scholar, OpenAlex, Web of Science, EconLit, working-paper series and trial registries, plus citation searching, with a PRISMA diagram. We code estimates comparing female and male teachers on test scores or grades, excluding interaction terms alone, which identify only the same-sex effect. The second is estimates we generate with a common specification from TIMSS, PIRLS and replication packages (nine found so far).

RQ1 is answered by counting studies and estimates per cell, using literature estimates only; generated estimates show how filling white spaces changes the picture. For RQ2, we expect to use random-effects models, which estimate the distribution of underlying effects net of sampling error. Evidence-dependent choices, such as publication-bias corrections, will be pre-registered after data collection but before analysis, or reported as not pre-registered.

As the search starts after the pre-analysis plan is registered, findings are expected, not preliminary. Related work, though on a different effect, motivates both hypotheses. On coverage, 501 of the 538 same-sex teacher estimates in de Gendre et al.'s (2024) meta-analysis use test scores and 375 come from secondary education. On heterogeneity, their multi-country analysis shows effects varying in sign across countries in primary but almost always positive in secondary education. If similar patterns hold for female-teacher effects, a pooled average mainly describes well-studied cells and may hide where effects change. The white spaces mark the limits of the evidence.

Keywords: female teachers, meta-analysis, design space, generalizability, meta-science

Session A2: Legitimacy, Institutions and Accountability **13:30–15:00** · RHMZ01

Regina Yan

School of Marketing and International Business

How ESG Signals Facilitate Cross-Border Mergers and Acquisitions: The Mediating Role of Host-Country Legitimacy and the Moderating Role of Geopolitical Distance

PRIMARY SUPERVISOR	Revti Raman
CONTRIBUTION	Paper presentation
DISCUSSANT	TBC
SESSION CHAIR	Nick Ashill
FACULTY MEMBER	Micael-Lee Johnstone
SLOT	Friday 30 October, 13:30–15:00, room RHMZ01 (presentation 1 of 3)

Abstract

Cross-border merger and acquisition (CBMA) is a crucial pathway for global expansion and resource acquisitions. An extensive body of literature exists on CBMA performance and outcomes. However, there has been a recent focus on understanding CBMA transaction completion and the transaction duration, i.e., the time taken to complete the acquisition. Many CBMAs do not materialise even after their announcement, or their completion is delayed because of contextual factors. Existing research highlights the clear impact of certain firm-level factors, while offering ambiguous and context-specific evidence for country-level and non-market strategy-related factors. So, it is important to understand why, despite increasingly abundant information and experience, CBMA transactions frequently fail, are postponed, or are even cancelled. Accordingly, this study focuses on what influences CBMA transaction completion and duration after entering the public disclosure period.

To answer the above questions, this study integrates institutional and signaling theories to construct a moderated mediation model. This study proposes that the acquirer's ESG signals enhance the host country's perceived legitimacy, thereby promoting CBMA completion and shortening transaction duration. Simultaneously, geopolitical distance, as a key boundary condition, negatively moderates the relationship between ESG signals and perceived legitimacy. This study employs a quantitative design, using cross-border M&A transactions initiated by Chinese multinational enterprises between 2010 and 2023 as the sample. It integrates data from SDC Platinum, Refinitiv ESG, Factiva media data and United Nations voting data, and utilises the Logit model and the Cox proportional hazards model to test a moderated mediation model. The robustness of the results will be analysed using different time lags, alternative proxies, and the instrumental-variables-based 2SLS method.

This study aims to contribute by establishing how ESG signals translate into legitimacy and impact the completion and duration of CBMA deals. Further, it highlights the moderating role of geopolitical distance, especially for MNEs from an emerging economy, i.e. China. Moreover, the study focuses on understanding the pre-completion-stage behaviour of CBMAs, thereby contributing to this less-understood area.

Keywords: Cross-border mergers and acquisitions, ESG performance, legitimacy, institutional theory, signaling theory

Session A2: Legitimacy, Institutions and Accountability **13:30–15:00** · RHMZ01

Stephen Liu

School of Information Management

From Formal Affiliation to Relationship Development: An Institutional Work Perspective on Policy-Shaped Digital Ecosystems

PRIMARY SUPERVISOR	Mary Tate
CONTRIBUTION	Paper presentation
DISCUSSANT	TBC
SESSION CHAIR	Nick Ashill
FACULTY MEMBER	Micael-Lee Johnstone
SLOT	Friday 30 October, 13:30–15:00, room RHMZ01 (presentation 2 of 3)

Abstract

This study examines how formal ecosystem affiliations develop into substantive relationships in policy-shaped digital ecosystems. Existing ecosystem frameworks, largely developed for market-driven contexts, provide limited account of this process in institutionally shaped environments, which forms the core motivation of this research. Drawing on institutional work, it explores how state-actor interventions become incorporated into focal firm–partner relationships, how these relationships develop over time, and how institutional work relates to differences in relationship quality. The study combines documentary evidence and targeted interviews to reconstruct relationship development and examine the processes underlying important changes. It is expected to identify distinct relationship trajectories and specify the mechanisms that drive divergent outcomes from the same initial formal affiliation. By distinguishing formal affiliation from substantive relationship development, the research provides a relationship-level explanation of how institutional work, external interventions, technical conditions, and relationship quality are connected over time, extending ecosystem theory to policy-shaped contexts.

Keywords: Digital ecosystems,institutional work,state-actor interventions,relationship development,relationship quality

Session A2: Legitimacy, Institutions and Accountability **13:30–15:00** · RHMZ01

Susie Hawthorne

School of Management

"That's Textbook": A Case Study of the Construction and Legitimation of Worker Participation in Introductory Management Textbooks

PRIMARY SUPERVISOR	Todd Bridgman
CONTRIBUTION	Roundtable or workshop contribution
DISCUSSANT	Verena Habrich
SESSION CHAIR	Nick Ashill
FACULTY MEMBER	Micael-Lee Johnstone
SLOT	Friday 30 October, 13:30–15:00, room RHMZ01 (presentation 3 of 3)

Abstract

Management textbooks shape what is regarded as legitimate management knowledge, yet they are socially produced and selective accounts (Apple, 2014; Issitt, 2004). Worker participation encompasses workers' involvement in and influence over decisions affecting their work, but its meanings are contested (Smith, 2006). Textbook research suggests that managerial perspectives often receive greater emphasis than workers' interests and collective influence (Bridgman & Cummings, 2021). This study asks why particular representations of worker participation have become legitimised within introductory management textbooks over time. A mixed methods case study will examine two textbook series: Principles of Management: An Analysis of Managerial Functions and Management: Concepts and Practices (Koontz & O'Donnell, 1955; Koontz et al., 2020; Robbins, 1984; Robbins et al., 2024). Selected for their longevity, prominence, and relevance, individual editions will support comparison within and between series. Only editions intended for U.S. higher education will be included, with historical coverage determined by availability and suitability.

Analysis comprises four steps. First, quantitative content analysis will examine variation in participation's presence, prominence, and visibility. A lexicon drawn from the International Labour Organization's glossary and relevant literature will be pilot tested and refined through contextual review (Arrigo & Casale, 2010; Short et al., 2010). Measures will capture references, frequency relative to edition length, textual space, and placement within prominent textbook features (Li et al., 2020). Patterns will guide passage selection for qualitative analysis. Second, qualitative content analysis will examine how participation is constructed and framed within selected passages and their context. Concept coding and comparison across editions will guide the development and refinement of interpretive categories (Hsieh & Shannon, 2005; Miles et al., 2020).

Third, historical analysis will examine developments in management education and the coercive, normative, and mimetic pressures shaping this context. Historical documents will be purposively selected for their potential to include these pressures and their relevance to textbook patterns (Hall & Taylor, 1996). Sources may include accreditation materials, educational policies, and scholarly and professional publications. Fourth, textbook patterns will be synthesised with the historical context to interpret how particular representations may become legitimised. Grounded in social constructionism, the study understands knowledge as socially constructed and context dependent (Berger & Luckmann, 1966; Burr, 2015). Alternative explanations will be considered to develop historically informed interpretations rather than claim definitive causality. A reflexive journal will document selection, coding, and interpretive decisions (Tracy, 2010).

The study anticipates continuity and variation in participation's visibility and framing over time, potentially including greater emphasis on managerial perspectives. These expectations remain open to revision. Given participation's contested scope, quantitative patterns may warrant narrowing the study to a particular form or dimension. Theoretically, the study aims to advance understanding of textbooks as institutional artefacts that may contribute to legitimising representations of worker participation. Methodologically, it offers a transparent mixed methods approach connecting quantitative and qualitative analysis with historical interpretation. Empirically, it will trace worker participation's visibility, terminology, and meaning across approximately 70 years. Practically, it encourages authors and publishers to reflect on textbooks' capacity to legitimise knowledge and how alternative perspectives could enrich students' understanding.

Keywords: Textbooks, Institutional Theory, Worker Participation, Management Education

Session A3: Families, Networks and Disaster Recovery **13:30–15:00** · RH207

Quanfu Zhang

School of Economics and Finance

Reconstructing Families in Linked Administrative Data: The Family Engine and an Application to Post-Earthquake Labour Adjustment

PRIMARY SUPERVISOR	Ilan Noy
CONTRIBUTION	Paper presentation
DISCUSSANT	TBC
SESSION CHAIR	Todd Bridgman
FACULTY MEMBER	Maja Krtalić
SLOT	Friday 30 October, 13:30–15:00, room RH207 (presentation 1 of 3)

Abstract

Family-level research using linked administrative data often relies on household and relationship variables that appear straightforward in cross-section but become difficult to interpret longitudinally. People move, relationships change, children age, and administrative sources differ in timing and evidential strength. These complications matter particularly in research on shocks, where the unit of analysis must be defined consistently before and after an event. This study asks two related questions: how can longitudinal family units be reconstructed from administrative records in a transparent, reproducible, and adaptable way, and do alternative family-construction rules materially affect conclusions about household labour-market adjustment after a major disaster? In the empirical application, I examine whether the 2011 Christchurch earthquake generated within-family labour reallocation, with responses differing between partnered and single-parent families and by the age composition of dependent children.

The study develops the Family Engine, a methodological framework for reconstructing longitudinal families while separating three stages often collapsed into a single coding rule: administrative evidence, inferred family state, and the final analytical definition selected by the researcher. Rather than imposing one universal definition of "family", the framework preserves competing evidence and allows researchers to specify decision rules through a transparent manifest. Its main contribution is methodological: family reconstruction becomes auditable, sensitivity to alternative definitions can be tested explicitly, and the same evidence can support different research questions. The framework is then applied to post-earthquake labour adjustment.

The Family Engine is implemented within Stats NZ's Integrated Data Infrastructure (IDI), combining Administrative Population Census (APC) family and household information with relationship and address evidence. The current implementation reconstructs family states nationally at annual reference dates from 2006 to 2024. It distinguishes observed from inferred states, retains ambiguity rather than forcing premature classification, and applies research-specific definitions only when constructing the analytical panel. Validation examines continuity, internal consistency, competing evidence, and sensitivity to alternative classification rules.

For the Christchurch application, families are identified before the 22 February 2011 earthquake and adult labour-market outcomes are followed over subsequent years. The analysis distinguishes partnered and single-parent families with dependent children, imposes pre-event stability requirements on adult family composition, and excludes major relationship transitions around the event. Outcomes include employment, earnings and hours worked. Causal effects are estimated using matched difference-in-differences and event-study designs, with alternative comparison groups and geographic restrictions as robustness checks.

Preliminary implementation results show that family reconstruction is empirically consequential. Plausible alternative rules can change who is classified as belonging to a family, whether a family is treated as continuous over time, and which observations enter the analytical sample. The Family Engine makes these choices visible rather than embedding them silently in preprocessing code. In the earthquake application, this allows labour responses to be compared across family structures and child-age groups while testing whether conclusions remain robust to alternative family definitions.

More broadly, the project treats longitudinal family construction as reusable research infrastructure rather than project-specific data cleaning. The intended outcome is an open framework that gives researchers greater control over family definitions while preserving a clear audit trail from administrative evidence to analytical sample.

Keywords: Linked administrative data; Family reconstruction; Labour supply; Natural disasters; Causal inference

Session A3: Families, Networks and Disaster Recovery **13:30–15:00** · RH207

Simin Yin

School of Information Management

Organising Chinese Immigrant Genealogical Sources and Family Networks through Information behaviour and Knowledge Graph

PRIMARY SUPERVISOR	Spencer Lilley
CONTRIBUTION	Paper presentation
DISCUSSANT	Wei Cai
SESSION CHAIR	Todd Bridgman
FACULTY MEMBER	Maja Krtalić
SLOT	Friday 30 October, 13:30–15:00, room RH207 (presentation 2 of 3)

Abstract

Purpose – Chinese immigrant genealogy reconstruction often depends on dispersed family records, oral histories, local chronicles, archives, inscriptions and community knowledge. Missing information and conflicting accounts complicate the organisation and verification of family relationships. This research investigates the information-seeking and information-organisation practices of Chinese immigrant communities in New Zealand to inform a knowledge-graph framework for maintaining family networks and inspecting their supporting evidence.

Design and methodology – The research combines surveys, semi-structured interviews, textual analysis, case studies and knowledge-graph modelling. A survey of about 100–200 participants will examine information channels, source preferences, trust evaluation, record-keeping and digital-tool use. Approximately 15–20 participants will be purposively selected for interviews, reflecting variation in age, migration background, genealogy experience and information literacy. Close reading and Python-assisted analysis of 50–100 publicly accessible or voluntarily provided materials will identify entities, relationships, sources and inconsistencies.

The findings will inform a model linking people and kinship assertions with sources, events, places, organisations and time periods, including provenance and uncertain or conflicting evidence. Selected cases will be modelled in Neo4j to develop an application for storing and updating family networks, linking source materials, searching and visualising relationships, and inspecting evidence. Ethical and cultural requirements for disclosure and living persons' data will inform development. Case-based checks will assess representation and traceability, while user tasks will evaluate source entry, relationship recording, evidence retrieval and interpretation of uncertainty. Task completion, errors and feedback will guide refinement.

Objectives – The study aims to understand genealogical information-seeking and verification practices; identify difficulties in integrating heterogeneous sources; and translate these findings into a knowledge-graph framework and application for reconstructing and managing family networks.

Findings – The research is in progress. Preliminary modelling and a case study of Nelson Wu's clan have explored how heterogeneous sources can be connected within a knowledge graph. This work highlights the need to link family relationships with evidence and historical context while retaining incomplete or competing claims. Prototype development and application evaluation remain planned stages.

Contribution – The study connects information behaviour with knowledge organisation by examining how users' research and verification practices inform conceptual modelling and application design. Its expected contribution is a framework for representing family relationships alongside their sources, provenance and uncertainty. The prototype will support the storage and exploration of family networks while retaining evidence links. Evaluation will inform design guidance for genealogists, Chinese community organisations and heritage institutions.

Keywords: Genealogy; Information behaviour; Knowledge graphs; Information organisation; Family networks;

Session A3: Families, Networks and Disaster Recovery **13:30–15:00** · RH207

Jadzil Baihaqi

School of Accounting and Commercial Law

Accountability of Religious Non-Government Organisations: Waqf Entities in Indonesia

PRIMARY SUPERVISOR	Carolyn Fowler
CONTRIBUTION	Paper presentation
DISCUSSANT	TBC
SESSION CHAIR	Todd Bridgman
FACULTY MEMBER	Maja Krtalić
SLOT	Friday 30 October, 13:30–15:00, room RH207 (presentation 3 of 3)

Abstract

Waqf (an Arabic term) is an Islamic endowment, a form of charity. Muslims donate their assets to a trustee, who manages them to derive benefits through investment or by using them directly for worship or other public purposes, such as a mosque, school and health facility. The donated assets are not owned by the trustee as ownership is transferred to God, represented by the waqf trustee, for societal welfare. Waqf assets are kept and only the benefit will be distributed to beneficiaries.

In recent times, the number of waqf entities has grown significantly in Indonesia. Anecdotal evidence and personal practical experiences suggest this has resulted in poor waqf accountability practices and regulation that is inadequate. Given that the prior literature indicates that the understanding of waqf accountability remains underdeveloped in the Indonesian context, this study aims to examine how Indonesian waqf entities discharge accountability to multiple stakeholders and how Islamic values shape that accountability. The research objectives are: 1) Examine the accountability relationships between waqf entities and their multiple stakeholders, including regulators, donors, beneficiaries, and the Muslim community; 2) Investigate the motivations that drive waqf entities' accountability practices; 3) Explore the mechanisms through which waqf entities discharge their accountability to different stakeholders; 4) Assess whether and how the modified principal-agent accountability framework that incorporates Islamic values explains waqf accountability practices in Indonesia.

Grounded in Ebrahim's principal-agent relationships accountability framework, which links accountability among multiple stakeholders, this study proposes a modified framework to incorporate Islamic accountability principles such as Tawhid (unity of God), khalifah (vicegerency), and Amanah (trust). The study argues that, by incorporating the Islamic accountability principles, waqf entities, as NGOs, serve as agents, with the Muslim community as the main principals. The proposed framework integrates both external motivations, driven by regulatory compliance, and internal motivations, grounded in organisational mission, culture, and religious belief.

Adopting an interpretivist view, this study will employ a qualitative multi-case study design across three purposively selected waqf entities: pure, hybrid, and complex waqf entities that operate privately. Data will be collected through document analysis and semi-structured interviews. Interviews will be conducted with waqf trustees, regulators, donors, beneficiaries, and Muslim community members.

This study will contribute theoretically as it extends the principal-agent accountability framework by integrating Islamic values as a core analytical dimension. The study will provide evidence on waqf accountability practices from multiple stakeholders' perspectives across diverse organisational settings. The study is also expected to provide practical insights to help in the development of regulations to strengthen waqf entities' accountability practices and public trust in Indonesia.

Keywords: Waqf, Accountability, NGO, Case study, Indonesia

Session A4: Learning, Development and Human Capability **13:30–15:00** · RHMZ02

Shanshan Liu

School of Marketing and International Business

Environmental Institutional Distance and the Environmental Performance of Foreign Subsidiaries in China: The Moderating Roles of Headquarters TMT Cognitive Diversity and Subsidiary CEO Experience

PRIMARY SUPERVISOR	Revti Raman
CONTRIBUTION	Paper presentation
DISCUSSANT	Yilin Ma, Regina Yan
SESSION CHAIR	Geoff Plimmer
FACULTY MEMBER	Janet Toland
SLOT	Friday 30 October, 13:30–15:00, room RHMZ02 (presentation 1 of 3)

Abstract

Research motivation
The role of multinational enterprises (MNEs) behaviour in contributing to environmental sustainability is contested. Since institutional arbitrage plays a key role in shifting advanced economy MNEs' (AMNEs) environmental malpractices onto offshore subsidiaries in emerging or less-developed economies, it is critical to understand the environmental performance of these subsidiaries.

Research questions
1. What is the relationship between environmental institutional distance and environmental performance of AMNEs' foreign subsidiaries in an emerging host country?

2. What are the moderating roles of HQs TMT cognitive diversity and subsidiary CEO experience in influencing the relationship between environmental institutional distance and environmental performance of AMNEs' foreign subsidiaries in an emerging host country?

Methodology and data
Quantitative, Longitudinal Panel regression, Non-experimental Design; Foriegn subsidiary level study; AMNEs subsidiaries operating in China;

Data from National Bureau of Statistics of China, China Ecological Environment Statistical Annual Report, National Pollutant Discharge Permit Management Information Platform, Yale center, OECD, Ecological Footprint of Nations, BoardEx and LSEG Workspace, company annual reports, subsidiary websites, executive profiles (e.g., LinkedIn), press releases and Oriana database.

Expected findings
1. Formal environmental institutional distance between home and China negatively impacts the environmental performance of AMNEs' foreign subsidiaries in China

2. Informal environmental institutional distance between home and China positively impacts the environmental performance of AMNEs' foreign subsidiaries in China

3. Headquarters TMT cognitive diversity weakens the negative impact of formal environmental institutional distance between home and China on the environmental performance of AMNEs' foreign subsidiaries in China.

4. Headquarters TMT cognitive diversity strengthens the positive impact of informal environmental institutional distance between home and China on the environmental performance of AMNEs' foreign subsidiaries in China.

5. Subsidiary CEO local experience weakens the negative impact of formal environmental institutional distance between home and China on the environmental performance of AMNEs' foreign subsidiaries in China.

6. Subsidiary CEO foreign experience strengthens the positive impact of informal environmental institutional distance between home and China on the environmental performance of AMNEs' foreign subsidiaries in China.

Contribution
We use an integrated view of the institutional and upper-echelons perspectives to answer why subsidiaries face similar environmental institutions yet exhibit different subsidiary environmental performance at the external and micro-foundation levels.

we contribute by demonstrating that the effects of EID on subsidiary environmental performance are not uniform but contingent on managerial interpretation and decision-making. We highlight the role of managers in shaping the influence of environmental institutional differences on organisational outcomes. Managers may enhance understanding beyond a compliance-based formal environmental view and recognise opportunities for capability development and environmental improvement. Moreover, we underscore the strategic importance of differences in informal environmental institutions between advanced home economies and emerging host economies, which can serve as sources of learning and adaptation rather than simply barriers to subsidiary operations. Managers may acknowledge the importance of the informal environmental institutional environment and take unified environmental practices within the organisation.

By examining AMNEs in China, an emerging economy, we build on existing EID – subsidiary performance literature which focused on advanced host context and resource-based view based moderators such as slack resources and financial performance.

Keywords: Environmental institutional distance, Headquarters TMT cognitive diversity, Subsidiary CEO experience, Environmental performance, foreign subsidiary

Session A4: Learning, Development and Human Capability **13:30–15:00** · RHMZ02

Oshone Momoh

School of Information Management

AI context transformation : Addressing undergraduates learning gaps in informal self directed study

PRIMARY SUPERVISOR	Allan Sylvester
CONTRIBUTION	Roundtable or workshop contribution
DISCUSSANT	Olivia Baldwin-Denton
SESSION CHAIR	Geoff Plimmer
FACULTY MEMBER	Janet Toland
SLOT	Friday 30 October, 13:30–15:00, room RHMZ02 (presentation 2 of 3)

Abstract

Motivation
During COVID-19, I struggled with online classes that assumed every student had steady internet, a quiet space, and the ability to figure things out alone.This is exactly how learning gaps occur: not less capability, but less room to catch up when material doesn't account for circumstances. COVID did not create this;it made it impossible to ignore gaps that had always existed, since family income, access to technology, and school background shape how much a student learns.Fixed formats worsen this, assuming every student can adapt to the same material under the same conditions, leaving those with less room further behind.A learning gap is the difference between what an undergraduate is expected to know or do, and what they currently can.It reflects opportunities they've had, not a flaw, and widens if ignored, since new learning builds on what came before. Gaps differ by student:some lack prior knowledge, some study in a second language, some live with a disability or reading difficulty, some face personal challenges, yet all get the same text-heavy slides and PDFs.This study focuses on the part content representation can address:when format doesn't match how a student best takes in information.In self-directed study, students must notice their own gap, decide how to close it, and judge whether it's closed.This takes real autonomy, freedom to engage with material that works for them, instead of one fixed format for everyone.Static resources inform but cannot respond, and benefiting from any tool first requires understanding one's own learning needs.AI could turn one resource into several formats, audio, video, interactive activity, so students choose what helps most.Current adaptive systems mostly adjust to performance history.This study examines whether a representation matched to a specific gap and context can help students address it, now and in future lifelong learning.

Research questions
What kinds of learning gaps do undergraduate students experience?How might AI-transformed formats support students experiencing learning gaps? (b) Which formats do they select, when given a choice?How can an AI context transformation framework help reduce learning gaps?

Research Contribution
This study offers two theoretical contributions and a practical one. First, building on Gregor's Type IV theory, the artefact, if it fits, will explain and predict how the fit between a student's gap, context, and AI-generated representation influences learning outcomes.Second, it examines how giving students choice over accessing material supports autonomy and intrinsic motivation.Together, these give a socio-technical understanding of how AI, learner needs, and choice work together, producing a working prototype students and support services can use.

Methodology
Two stages: a preliminary qualitative stage, followed by Design Science Research (DSR). Participants: 10-15 second- and third-year undergraduates, recruited via the student learning support service and supervisors' course contacts.By this point, gaps more likely reflect content engagement, not transition difficulty. Ethics approval will be sought before data collection.Stage 1 (RQ1): mid-Trimester 1, once students have had time to experience real gaps, semi-structured interviews explore gaps faced, how students try closing them, and informal AI use.Data is analysed thematically, letting gap types emerge from students' own accounts.The most prominent gap and cause carries into Stage 2.Stage 2 (RQ2-RQ3): the same students co-design an AI context transformation prototype, built on existing AI APIs (text-to-speech, text-to-video), targeting the Stage 1 gap, keeping design grounded in a real need and testing whether it helped those who described the gap. Before term ends, I evaluate which formats students choose and whether the material narrows their gap.

Expected Findings
a grounded typology of learning gaps and early evidence that gap-matched AI formats improve student understanding.

Keywords: Learning gaps, AI context transformation, self-directed learning, Design Science Research, Adaptive learning

Session A4: Learning, Development and Human Capability **13:30–15:00** · RHMZ02

Ryan Meachen

School of Management

Ideal-Self-Actualization: Toward Fulfilling the Conceptual and Empirical Potential of Self-Actualization

PRIMARY SUPERVISOR	Ben Walker
CONTRIBUTION	Paper presentation and Roundtable or workshop contribution
DISCUSSANT	TBC
SESSION CHAIR	Geoff Plimmer
FACULTY MEMBER	Janet Toland
SLOT	Friday 30 October, 13:30–15:00, room RHMZ02 (presentation 3 of 3)

Abstract

For nearly a century, self-actualization has been one of psychology's most enchanting ideas, but also one of its most conceptually ambiguous and empirically elusive. Most of us can name someone we believe is fulfilling their potential, but self-actualization scholars has struggled to clearly articulate what that means, or how we would know. I argue that the field has been missing a fundamental question: actualizing toward what? Because no one can know their true potential in any inherent sense, we need a reference point to guide self-actualization in the meantime. I propose that this missing reference point is the ideal self.

This research asks three questions. How can self-actualization be defined so that it is both faithful to its theoretical lineage and tractable for empirical research? Can it be measured? And does it matter for how people's lives go?

I begin with a review of eight major perspectives on self-actualization, showing that the literature has accumulated a rich array of theoretical contentions about what self-actualization is and how it can be achieved, while leaving the field without a shared definition or an agreed reference point. In response, I introduce ideal-self-actualization (ISA) — the conscious pursuit and experience of being or becoming one's ideal self — which integrates common conceptual threads from existing perspectives while addressing critical blind spots across them. I then test this framework using a three-wave survey of US employees over six months (N = 238), developing the Ideal-Self-Actualization Scale (ISAS) and examining how ISA relates to wellbeing over time.

The findings suggest that ISA coheres as a brief and stable measure, and that it captures something existing measures of wellbeing and self-actualization do not. They also reveal a layer of self-actualization that the ISAS alone cannot reach: being one's ideal self and becoming one's ideal self turn out to be two distinct experiences, each with its own consequences for wellbeing.

This research makes three categories of contribution. Conceptually, it offers what is to my knowledge the first comparative review of eight major self-actualization perspectives, and proposes ideal-self-actualization as a pathway forward anchored to a single reference point. Methodologically, it provides a brief and psychometrically sound measure of ISA. Nomologically, it provides what is to my knowledge the first longitudinal evidence that self-actualization prospectively predicts life satisfaction. Together, these contributions open self-actualization — long an enchanting idea for psychology — to empirical inquiry.

Keywords: self-actualization, identity, motivation, happiness, well-being

Student-Led Workshop **15:30–16:15** · RHMZ01

Lacy Jeffreys

School of Management

The life-changing magic of writing it up: Tips and tricks for writing your thesis manuscript

PRIMARY SUPERVISOR	Karin Lasthuizen
CONTRIBUTION	Roundtable or workshop contribution
DISCUSSANT	Yana Geary
SLOT	Friday 30 October, 15:30–16:15, room RHMZ01

Abstract

You are invited to an interactive, community-building doctoral writing discussion hosted by Lacy Jeffreys, a PhD candidate in the School of Management who recently submitted her thesis. The session will focus on writing strategies and resources to help you complete your manuscript. This session is for anyone who would like tips on dealing with the blank page, brainstorming, or writing clearly.

Keywords: Writing, research, thesis